# ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 9: **Agriculture (Geography)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

## SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(c)** groundnut | Sown in monsoon |
| 2 | **(b)** Kerala and Karnataka | South Indian hills |
| 3 | **(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A. | Both true; R explains A |
| 4 | **(b)** wheat | Rabi crop |
| 5 | **(a)** health concerns and demand for chemical-free food | Consumer awareness |
| 6 | **(a)** Kharif sowing | Monsoon season |
| 7 | **(b)** cotton - black soil | Regur soil retains moisture |
| 8 | **(c)** gram | Gram is a legume |
| 9 | **(b)** crop rotation | Alternating crops |
| 10 | **(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A. | Both true; R explains A |

## SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Farmers borrow for inputs and crops fail or prices fall (1); They cannot repay loans and fall into distress (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Fruits and vegetables give higher income (1); They create employment and improve nutrition (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | Most farming depends on monsoon rain (1); If it fails, crops fail and farmers lose income (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Export demand makes farmers shift to profitable crops (1); They may grow cash crops instead of food crops (1). | 1+1 |

## SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Cooperatives give credit and marketing to farmers (1); They help in collective bargaining (1); Dairy cooperatives show success (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Pulses give lower profit than wheat and rice (1); They are grown on poor land with little irrigation (1); Yields are low so supply is short of demand (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | HYV seeds raise yield (1); Fertilisers and irrigation add nutrients and water (1); Machines save time and labour (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Fruits and vegetables earn foreign exchange (1); They give higher income to farmers (1); Exports create jobs in packing and transport (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Land reforms gave land to tillers (1); Cooperatives and credit helped farmers (1); But implementation has been uneven (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Heat waves and uneven rain hit crop yields (1); Floods and droughts increase (1); Farmers face greater uncertainty (1). | 1+1+1 |

## SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | The Green Revolution of the 1960s introduced HYV seeds, chemical fertilisers and assured irrigation, raising wheat and rice output and making India self-sufficient in foodgrains (1); The gains were concentrated in Punjab, Haryana and western Uttar Pradesh, where irrigation was available (1); Other regions and crops such as pulses lagged behind, widening regional disparities (1); Small farmers could not afford inputs, so inequality grew (1); Heavy use of chemicals and groundwater has harmed soil and water, so sustainability is questioned (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Agriculture employs about two-thirds of India's population and supplies food and raw materials (1); Rural incomes support demand for industrial goods (1); Its share in GDP has fallen as industry and services grew faster (1); Industry and services give higher incomes but still depend on farm output (1); So prosperity depends on balanced growth, with agriculture strengthened rather than neglected (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **20** | Technological reforms include HYV seeds, fertilisers, pesticides, machines and irrigation, which raise yield per hectare (1); Institutional reforms include land consolidation, abolition of zamindari and land ceilings that change ownership (1); Kisan Credit Card and Personal Accident Insurance Scheme gave easy credit and insurance to farmers (1); Minimum support price and procurement assure farmers fair prices, and Operation Flood improved incomes in milk (1); Both types are needed because technology alone benefits only the better-off, while land reform alone does not raise productivity (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Types of farming include primitive subsistence (slash and burn, called jhumming in the north-east), intensive subsistence in densely populated areas, commercial farming with HYV seeds and fertilisers, and plantation farming of a single crop on large estates (1); India has three cropping seasons: Rabi (sown in winter, e.g. wheat, mustard, gram), Kharif (sown with the monsoon, e.g. rice, cotton, jute, groundnut) and Zaid (summer, e.g. watermelon and cucumber) (1); Main crops are foodgrains (rice, wheat, millets, pulses), cash crops (sugarcane, oilseeds, cotton, jute) and plantation crops (tea, coffee, rubber) (1); Rice needs temperature above 25 degrees Celsius and rain over 100 cm, wheat needs a cool growing season and 50 to 75 cm rain, and cotton grows best in black soil (1); This diversity follows variation in climate, soil, irrigation and technology across regions (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 9: **Agriculture (Geography)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A. | Both true; R explains A |
| 2 | **(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A. | Both true; R explains A |
| 3 | **(d)** the Green Revolution | HYV seeds and irrigation |
| 4 | **(b)** minimum support price | MSP |
| 5 | **(a)** dependence on moneylenders at high interest | Informal credit |
| 6 | **(c)** double cropping | Two crops in a year |
| 7 | **(d)** A is false but R is true. | A false; R true |
| 8 | **(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A. | Both true; R explains A |
| 9 | **(b)** needs a large labour force and capital | Commercial estates |
| 10 | **(d)** Punjab, Haryana and Uttar Pradesh | Ganga-Satluj plains |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Rice needs standing water during growth (1); This needs heavy rain or large irrigation (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Institutional credit has lower interest (1); Moneylenders charge high rates and trap farmers in debt (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | It shows soil nutrients (1); Farmers can use the right fertiliser, saving money and soil (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | Scattered small plots are costly to irrigate and cultivate (1); Machines cannot be used and yields stay low (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Punjab uses irrigation, HYV seeds and grows wheat and rice commercially (1); Assam gets heavy rain and grows tea and rice (1); Punjab has mechanised farms, Assam has plantations and small farms (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | Prices fluctuate with seasons and trade (1); Stable prices help farmers plan (1); MSP and insurance reduce risk (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | Kharif needs monsoon rain and warmth (1); Rabi needs cool winter and sunshine (1); So rice suits Kharif and wheat suits Rabi (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Middlemen take a large share (1); Storage and transport costs are high (1); Farmers get low prices while consumers pay more (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | Canals and tube wells allowed two or three crops a year (1); Water-intensive crops such as rice spread to dry areas (1); This lowered water tables (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Cotton and jute feed textile industries (1); Sugarcane supplies sugar mills (1); Oilseeds supply oil mills (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Problems include small and fragmented holdings, dependence on monsoon, indebtedness to moneylenders, low prices and competition from cheap imports after globalisation (1); The government has introduced minimum support prices and procurement to assure farmers' income (1); Kisan Credit Card gives institutional credit and crop insurance covers losses from drought, flood and pests (1); Land reforms such as consolidation of holdings and abolition of zamindari aimed at fairer ownership (1); Implementation is uneven, so diversification into horticulture, irrigation and cooperatives is needed (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Agriculture supplies raw materials such as cotton and jute for textiles, sugarcane for sugar mills and oilseeds for oil mills (1); Industry supplies fertilisers, pesticides, machines and tractors to farmers (1); Farm incomes create demand for industrial and consumer goods (1); Agro-based industries employ rural people (1); Growth in one therefore stimulates the other (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **20** | After globalisation, cheap imports of agricultural goods compete with Indian produce, lowering prices for farmers (1); Small and marginal farmers lack resources to adapt and fall into debt (1); Export opportunities exist for rice, spices, tea and fruits, but mostly larger farmers benefit (1); Price instability makes farming risky (1); Government support through MSP, credit and technology is needed to protect farmers (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Intensive farming uses high doses of chemical fertilisers and pesticides, which reduce soil fertility over time (1); It draws heavily on groundwater, lowering water tables and causing salinity from over-irrigation (1); Monocropping reduces biodiversity and increases pests (1); It raises output in the short run but harms long-term productivity (1); Organic farming, crop rotation and soil conservation are needed to make it sustainable (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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## ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 9: **Agriculture (Geography)** | Class 10 Social Science | Maximum Marks: 40

### SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

| Q. | Correct Option | Brief Reasoning |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A. | Both true; R explains A |
| 2 | **(a)** Kharif - June-July | Kharif follows the monsoon |
| 3 | **(d)** it gives assured price and income | Cash crop |
| 4 | **(d)** high yield per unit area from small land | Labour-intensive |
| 5 | **(a)** Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A. | Both true; R explains A |
| 6 | **(c)** India is the largest producer and consumer of pulses | Pulses are a protein source |
| 7 | **(a)** sugarcane | Grown in UP, Maharashtra, Karnataka |
| 8 | **(a)** loss of forest cover | Slash and burn clears forest |
| 9 | **(b)** tea - Gujarat | Tea is grown in Assam, West Bengal and the south |
| 10 | **(d)** use of fertilisers | Inputs for higher output |

### SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 11 | Cash crops reduce land for food crops (1); Food prices rise when food crops are fewer (1). | 1+1 |
| 12 | Women are major members of dairy cooperatives (1); Milk sales give them independent income (1). | 1+1 |
| 13 | It reduces dependence on one crop (1); It spreads risk and raises income (1). | 1+1 |
| 14 | MSP raises prices and costs the government (1); It encourages a few crops and may distort cropping patterns (1). | 1+1 |

### SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 15 | Oilseeds give edible oil (1); India imports edible oil (1); Higher production saves foreign exchange (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 16 | They have small holdings (1); They lack irrigation, credit and markets (1); They depend on rain and moneylenders (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 17 | MSP gives assured prices (1); Government procurement encourages wheat and rice (1); Farmers shift from other crops (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Overuse of fertilisers harms soil (1); It pollutes water (1); Yields eventually fall (1). | 1+1+1 |
| 18 | The Green Revolution raised output (1); But heavy chemicals harmed soil and water (1); It widened gaps between rich and poor farmers and regions (1). | 1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Plantation labour works long hours for low wages (1); Housing and facilities are poor (1); Jobs are seasonal and insecure (1). | 1+1+1 |

### SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

| Q. | Expected Answer / Value Points | Marks |
|---|---|---|
| 19 | Cooperatives give farmers credit, inputs and marketing, and dairy cooperatives raised incomes under Operation Flood (1); Minimum support price assures a price floor and procurement ensures a buyer (1); Institutional credit through banks and Kisan Credit Card reduces dependence on moneylenders (1); Together they reduce rural poverty and stabilise farm incomes (1); They work only if farmers are aware and the system is free from delay and corruption (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Tea, coffee and rubber are plantation crops grown on large estates with heavy capital and a large labour force (1); Tea needs a warm, moist, frost-free climate and well-drained soil, and grows in Assam, the hills of Darjeeling and the south (1); Coffee of the Arabica variety, brought from Yemen, is grown in the Nilgiris of Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu (1); They earn foreign exchange through exports and supply raw material to industry (1); Challenges include low wages and poor conditions for workers, price fluctuations in the international market and competition (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **20** | North India grows wheat and rice mainly in the irrigated alluvial plains of the Ganga-Satluj, with the Green Revolution concentrated in Punjab and Haryana (1); The south grows rice, millets, cotton, sugarcane and spices, with plantation crops like tea, coffee and rubber in the hills of Kerala, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu (1); Rabi crops are more important in the north because of winter rain from western disturbances (1); Soils differ: alluvial in the north and black, red and laterite in the south (1); Both regions are important for national food security (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |
| | **OR:** Temperature decides the crop season and type: rice needs warmth above 25 degrees Celsius and wheat a cool winter (1); Rainfall decides whether a crop can be grown without irrigation: rice needs over 100 cm and rubber over 200 cm (1); Soil matters: alluvial soil suits wheat and sugarcane, black soil cotton and laterite tea, coffee and cashew (1); Irrigation and technology can modify these patterns, as in Punjab (1); Hence cropping patterns across India follow natural conditions as well as human inputs (1). | 1+1+1+1+1 |

**Evaluator's note:** Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

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